CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 20

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- It had the wrong name on it.
- It was not finished cooking.
- It got damaged in the box.
- It was not decorated at all.

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- a few minutes
- 15 minutes
- around one hour
- 20 minutes

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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-
-
-

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- bake another cake
- take the cake away
- check the original order
- notify her supervisor

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- angry
- impatient
- confused
- worried

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He fired one of the bakery employees.
- He introduced new rules for bakery staff.
- He sent the man a complimentary cake.
- He created an allergy list.

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- She cares about her customers.
- She has a child with a food allergy.
- She is able to offer discounts.
- She asks about chocolate allergies.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- The woman will call her manager again.
- The man will ask for a larger discount.
- The man will order another cake.
- The woman will make a frosting-free cake.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ at home
- ◯ at the mall
- ◯ at work
- ◯ on the bus

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ camping
- ◯ fishing
- ◯ hiking
- ◯ running

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He distracted them with food.
- ◯ He honked an air horn.
- ◯ He ran uphill quickly.
- ◯ He shouted loudly.

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ confusing
- ◯ exciting
- ◯ ordinary
- ◯ unreal

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ camp in the woods
- ◯ explore the mall
- ◯ find the bears
- ◯ photograph wild animals

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He was once one of the woman's teachers.
- ◯ He created the method mentioned by the woman.
- ◯ He taught music at the same place as the woman.
- ◯ He was contacted in advance by the woman.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ to obtain advice
- ◯ to provide information
- ◯ to make a complaint
- ◯ to seek clarification

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ They have many principles in common.
- ◯ They are extremely successful.
- ◯ They don’t make learning fun.
- ◯ They don't emphasize practice.

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ They should be minimal.
- ◯ They should be accurate.
- ◯ They should be part of the lesson.
- ◯ They should be done quickly.

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ accept children’s limitations
- ◯ expect all children to pay attention
- ◯ reprimand gently to increase attention
- ◯ use signs to help children pay attention

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ appreciated
- ◯ obligated
- ◯ favoured
- ◯ pleased

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. Previously, the library's computers _____
- ◯ cost nothing for the public.
- ◯ charged a small user fee.
- ◯ required a membership card.
- ◯ had to be booked in advance.

2. Smith called the press to _____
- ◯ make a complaint about sports.
- ◯ inform the public of some changes.
- ◯ encourage greater use of public libraries.
- ◯ ask for book and computer donations.

3. Books unavailable at Rickman Library _____
- ◯ can be read online.
- ◯ will soon be purchased.
- ◯ were not returned by others.
- ◯ may be requested.

4. Implementing fees will enable _____
- ◯ the library to remain in business.
- ◯ more special service requests.
- ◯ the library to pay off its debts.
- ◯ Smith to purchase more library books.

5. Smith thinks the government's decision _____
- ◯ is a good one.
- ◯ will affect mostly girls.
- ◯ is a poor one.
- ◯ will not make a difference.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What is the purpose of the meeting?
- ◯ to brainstorm ideas
- ◯ to evaluate a program
- ◯ to discuss a new policy
- ◯ to learn about software

2. What topic are the people discussing?
- ◯ lack of employee training
- ◯ issues with the new software
- ◯ viable training methods
- ◯ possibly buying new software

3. What is Claire's concern about relying on the user manual?
- ◯ It may just be thrown out.
- ◯ It is boring to read through.
- ◯ It may not be detailed enough.
- ◯ It is only available online.

4. How does Ted feel about his first suggestion?
- ◯ It is not his best idea.
- ◯ It requires too much work.
- ◯ It was meant as a joke.
- ◯ It may not be simple.

5. What is Edward's main concern about training workshops?
- ◯ The company trainers are too busy to give workshops.
- ◯ Their office does not have enough space to hold them.
- ◯ They need someone qualified to lead them.
- ◯ Staff may not want to attend them.

6. What is the disadvantage mentioned about an online training module?
- ◯ Staff may neglect to complete it.
- ◯ It requires resources to develop.
- ◯ It could be very expensive.
- ◯ Employees would rather interact.

PART 5

7. What do the three people decide to do at the end?

- ◯ find surveys about training
- ◯ get assistance from IT
- ◯ reconsider all options
- ◯ gather input from staff

8. What field do the employees likely work in?

- ◯ business services
- ◯ scientific research
- ◯ higher education
- ◯ public health care

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. A supporter of the stakeholder view might suggest corporations should ____

- ◯ distribute profits evenly among shareholders.
- ◯ involve executives in corporate decisions.
- ◯ spend money on community-based projects.
- ◯ request financial assistance from government.

2. Economist Milton Friedman references government to _____

- ◯ show a similarity to corporations.
- ◯ contrast the duties of corporations.
- ◯ describe a problem faced by corporations.
- ◯ exemplify how corporations are overseen.

3. Ethicist Margaret White would agree with Friedman that _____

- ◯ companies serve the public by making money.
- ◯ corporations cannot have moral responsibilities.
- ◯ government should not interfere with business.
- ◯ charity cannot be mandatory for companies.

4. White suggests that corporations are often _____

- ◯ supportive of developing communities.
- ◯ as generous as charitable organizations.
- ◯ unfairly blamed for problems.
- ◯ able to avoid moral obligations.

5. According to the presentation, more people nowadays _____

- ◯ support socially responsible companies.
- ◯ want to work for ethical organizations.
- ◯ are interested in producing their own products.
- ◯ are doubtful of messages in marketing.

6. The speaker suggests that companies _____

- ◯ care about more than merely increasing their profits.
- ◯ have agreed they have social responsibilities.
- ◯ sometimes misrepresent themselves to sell products.
- ◯ cause harm by not contributing to social welfare.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	It had the wrong name on it.
Question 2	15 minutes
Question 3	
Question 4	notify her supervisor
Question 5	angry
Question 6	He introduced new rules for bakery staff.
Question 7	She cares about her customers.
Question 8	The man will order another cake.

PART 2	
Question 1	at work
Question 2	hiking
Question 3	He distracted them with food.
Question 4	exciting
Question 5	camp in the woods

PART 3	
Question 1	He was contacted in advance by the woman.
Question 2	to obtain advice
Question 3	They don't make learning fun.
Question 4	They should be accurate.
Question 5	accept children's limitations
Question 6	pleased

PART 4	
Question 1	cost nothing for the public.
Question 2	inform the public of some changes.
Question 3	may be requested.
Question 4	the library to remain in business.
Question 5	is a poor one.

PART 5	
Question 1	to brainstorm ideas
Question 2	viable training methods
Question 3	It is boring to read through.
Question 4	It is not his best idea.
Question 5	They need someone qualified to lead them.
Question 6	It requires resources to develop.
Question 7	gather input from staff
Question 8	business services

PART 6	
Question 1	spend money on community-based projects.
Question 2	contrast the duties of corporations.
Question 3	charity cannot be mandatory for companies.
Question 4	able to avoid moral obligations.
Question 5	support socially responsible companies.
Question 6	sometimes misrepresent themselves to sell products.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman at a grocery store bakery. The woman works at the store. The man is a customer.

Section 1:

MAN: Hello, could you please help me? I ordered this birthday cake and picked it up this morning. But when I opened it just now to put it on the table, I discovered that it says, "Happy 10th Birthday, David"! It's supposed to say, "Happy 10th Birthday, Matthew"!

WOMAN: No problem, we can just order another one.

MAN: No, that won't do! My son's party starts in an hour. I'm afraid I need a cake now.

WOMAN: Okay, still not a problem. I can scrape the frosting off the top and re-decorate it. You'll never notice the difference.

MAN: Are you sure? Okay . . .

WOMAN: I can do it right now. Can you come back in fifteen minutes?

MAN: Okay, thanks, I'll just go pick up a few extra things for the party. I'll be back in twenty.

Now answer questions 1-2.

1. What was the problem with the cake?
2. How long will it take to fix the cake?

Section 2:

WOMAN: Hello, how did the birthday party go?

MAN: It was a disaster. I ordered a cherry cake. The cake was chocolate. Matthew is allergic to chocolate.

WOMAN: Oh, I'm so sorry. There must have been a mix-up not only with the decoration, but with the cake itself. I'll see to it that you get a full refund.

MAN: I'm afraid that won't be good enough. Matthew saw the cake and I had to take it away from him. He was so upset!

WOMAN: Oh dear, I really am sorry. Let me contact the manager.

MAN: Please do that. Nuts and bee stings aren't the only things people are allergic to!

Now answer questions 3-5.

3. What kind of cake did the man want?
4. What does the woman do?
5. How is the man feeling?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: Hello, your conversation with our manager was satisfactory?

MAN: Yes, thanks. He told me that he would be implementing new procedures in the bakery department so that kind of mistake would never happen again.

WOMAN: Yes, we have a list of ingredients that are possible problems, and we are instructed to ask the customer not once, but twice, about allergies. We are also supposed to tell the customer whether any of the ingredients on the list are in the products ordered.

MAN: Well, that's good news. I don't want what happened to Matthew to happen to anyone else.

WOMAN: Nor do I, and I apologize again. We have been careful about nuts, but I've never even heard of an allergy to chocolate.

MAN: Well, every day there seems to be something new that kids are allergic to, so I think it's best to stay on top of it.

WOMAN: I agree. I hope the manager also gave you a discount on future orders. I do hope you will order your next birthday cake from us!

MAN: Well, actually, that's why I'm here . . .

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. What action did the manager take?
7. What is likely true of the woman?
8. What will likely happen next?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You are about to hear a conversation between a man and a woman.

MAN: Good morning, Rebecca.

WOMAN: Morning Jason. Do you want to grab a coffee down the hall?

MAN: Sure. Let's go. How was your weekend?

WOMAN: It wasn't bad. There was a huge sale at Metrotown, so I did some shopping. How about you? How was your weekend?

MAN: It was awesome! You'll never guess what happened.

WOMAN: You didn't catch another prize salmon, did you? That was an amazing first attempt!

MAN: No, I didn't go out on the water. My buddy and I went for a hike out at Golden Ears Park, and we came face to face with a huge black bear! I mean, he was massive. Actually, pardon me, I should say 'she,' as there were two cubs with her.

WOMAN: Oh my goodness! What did you do? You didn't run, I hope!

MAN: No. It just so happened that I had a bag of peanut butter sandwiches in my hand. So, I threw the bag of sandwiches as far as I could, past the bears. I guess they smelled the peanut butter and went to investigate. We were so lucky. Those sandwiches must have smelled better than we did, because the bears ripped open the bag and started eating them.

WOMAN: And you stuck around to watch them?

MAN: Not a chance! We took off and headed for the car. I've never moved so fast in my life! Luckily, we had hiked uphill, so the sprint back down to the car wasn't too bad. We jumped in, locked the doors and tore out of there so fast. Next time I go hiking, I'm bringing one of those cans of air that works as a horn. I heard that noise is the best way to get rid of a bear.

WOMAN: You are one lucky guy. How come that kind of thing never happens to me?

MAN: Well, you don't see many bears at the mall!

WOMAN: Very funny. I'm going camping at Harrison next weekend. Maybe I'll have a wildlife encounter to tell you about next Monday.

MAN: Just be careful!

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. Where are Jason and Rebecca?
2. What did Jason do last weekend?
3. How did Jason get away from the bears?
4. How would Rebecca describe Jason's experience?
5. What will Rebecca do next weekend?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation between two people about teaching.

MAN: Hello Ellen, come on in. What did you want to see me about?

WOMAN: Thank you, Bob, and thanks for meeting with me. I'm going to be working at a children's camp this summer, and part of my job will involve teaching them things like games, songs, dances . . . that sort of thing. I was hoping you could give me some tips.

MAN: That sounds fun! Well, let me see . . . First and foremost, make it fun. Children like to play. We all do. Learning something requires a lot of practice, and the more fun it is, the more likely they'll spend the time they need practicing.

WOMAN: Yes, there's a certain method . . . I can't remember the name right now . . . a certain method of teaching music that uses that basic principle. And it's very successful. More successful than many traditional methods. Maybe that's why.

MAN: At the same time, you must recognize that practice involves repetition. Many children will want to do something once or twice and be done with it, but that won't be enough. More importantly, each repetition must be done correctly. Otherwise, they'll be practicing how to do it wrong.

WOMAN: How can I make sure they are practicing correctly? I can't go home with them; I can't watch them practice all the time.

MAN: No, but if possible, involve their parents. They can watch them at home. That's another tip I highly recommend.

WOMAN: Okay, thanks, anything else? I was wondering about attention span techniques. Children have very short attention spans.

MAN: They do indeed. So, keep the lessons and practice times short. Two minutes of attention is better than 10 minutes of distraction. Five 2-minute sessions is better than one 10-minute session.

WOMAN: Got it. I'll remember that. I'll make a big sign in my head! What about when they don't get it? Some children are more competent than others.

MAN: Be patient. Do not punish; do not even reprimand. That's the quickest way to lose them. If they want to learn what you're teaching, eventually they'll come around.

WOMAN: And if they don't want to learn what I'm teaching, it's probably just as well. Not everyone has to learn everything!

MAN: Exactly. Hmmm, I can't think of anything else at the moment . . .

WOMAN: All right then, I'll let you get on with your day, and I want to thank you again for your tips.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. What is probably true about the man?
2. Why does the woman arrange the meeting?
3. What does the woman think about some traditional teaching methods?
4. What does the man think about repetitions?
5. What does the man say about attention span?
6. How does the woman feel at the end of the conversation?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about a community development issue.

Sharon Smith, Head Librarian at Rickman Public Library, has reported that the library's grant from the government will not be renewed for the coming year. Consequently, the library will start charging patrons for computer time, the amount not yet decided upon. Furthermore, she reports, although patrons may continue to make special requests for books not available at the library, there will be a five-dollar fee for books available elsewhere in the region. The fee for books outside the region will increase from five dollars to ten dollars. Lastly, residents will have to pay a small annual membership fee. Up to now, only non-residents have had to pay for membership privileges.

Smith said that they regret doing this, but they're just trying to keep the library open. Today she learned that the province is providing grants for recreation instead of libraries. While conceding that recreation is important, Smith was upset that the government is funding costly football leagues instead of the cheaper soccer games. She explained that not only are the equipment expenses less for soccer, but it's also more inclusive because there are girls' teams and boys' teams, and leagues for all ages.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three employees. There are two men and one woman. They are meeting to discuss a change at work.

Edward: So, as you've likely heard, the company's purchased a new software program to manage the client database. Now this means we're going to have to retrain all the sales representatives on how to use the new system. I've called you here to discuss some effective, yet inexpensive, training options.

Ted: Hmmm . . . well, I know that the program comes with a user guide. One option would be to have the employees read the guide and try to figure it out on their own. It's definitely a cost-effective option.

Claire: I'm sorry Ted, but that sounds so tedious! I've seen that user guide, and it is not short. It's certainly an inexpensive option, but probably not an effective one. I mean, what if people have questions about the information in the guide? What if they didn't even read it?

Ted: Yeah . . . it probably wouldn't be an appealing task. I was just throwing it out there. How about holding a training workshop? That way, people could attend in person and get hands-on experience.

Edward: Yeah, hands-on training is definitely effective. I think the drawback there could be finding a time for the workshop amongst everybody's busy work schedules. And we'd have to hire a trainer. That could get tricky.

Ted: Actually, I don't think we'd need to hire from outside. I know Paul in IT has a lot of experience using the program. We could ask him to deliver a workshop or two.

Claire: That would definitely save us from having to hire someone. I learn best with interactive training workshops. I like that option the best so far.

Edward: Another thing I've been considering is an online training module. Now, that way we could ensure that everyone has completed the training, and they could do it whenever they have time.

Claire: That sounds convenient, but kind of complicated. I mean, we'd have to hire someone with computer skills to create the module; it might take a lot of time. But it could be easier than scheduling a bunch of workshop training sessions.

Ted: Well, we've got three options . . . or actually, two. I think we can rule out the first one. Why don't we send out a quick survey to the employees and get their feedback?

Edward: Sounds great! Ted, do you mind organizing that?

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about social responsibility.

The sole responsibility of a corporation, according to economist Milton Friedman, is to make money. A corporation exists to serve its shareholders—that is, any entity which owns any part of the company—whose goal is to increase the value of their investment in that company. As long as the decisions made by a company's executives further this aim, a corporation is fulfilling its duty.

Profits aside, if a company's actions harm its employees, customers, the community, or the environment, surely this must be problematic. In recent decades, more people have realized that these affected groups, known as stakeholders, deserve consideration in corporate decision making. In contrast to Friedman's shareholder view, the stakeholder view contends that corporations have an obligation to integrate social and environmental concerns into their business model. For example, corporations should contribute to community development, pay respectable wages, or donate to worthy causes.

For Milton Friedman, however, addressing social issues is the responsibility of the government, not corporations. Asking companies to spend revenue on social welfare is akin to imposing taxation on shareholders. Friedman makes it clear that corporations are not public servants and so are not responsible to the public. What's more, a corporation, as an artificial construct, does not have moral or social responsibilities in the same sense as people. For Friedman, the sole social responsibility of a corporation is to maximize profits while obeying the law.

Ethicist Margaret White says Friedman is right in one sense. While it would undoubtedly be kind for a rich company to give money to a community struggling economically, we can no more require a company to hand out donations than we can require a person to give money to someone on the street who asks for change. Charity should not be mandated.

White points out that in many cases, however, corporations are inextricably linked to social or environmental problems. Many companies, for example, find legal loopholes to irresponsibly dispose of their waste. Though they manage to skirt the law, companies, just like people, should be held morally responsible for the consequences of their actions.

Interestingly, whether companies agree or disagree with White, it's now in their interest to adopt a socially responsible position. With the rise of ethics-influenced consumerism, shoppers are demanding that products be produced with the concerns of labourers, animals, and the environment in mind. Sadly, as a by-product, this has also given rise to a form of "greenwashing" in advertising, where companies market themselves with an environmentally friendly image for the sole interest of increasing sales.